

CYBERPUNK DEV

The story of Alita, from the scrapyard to Mars

Story abstract

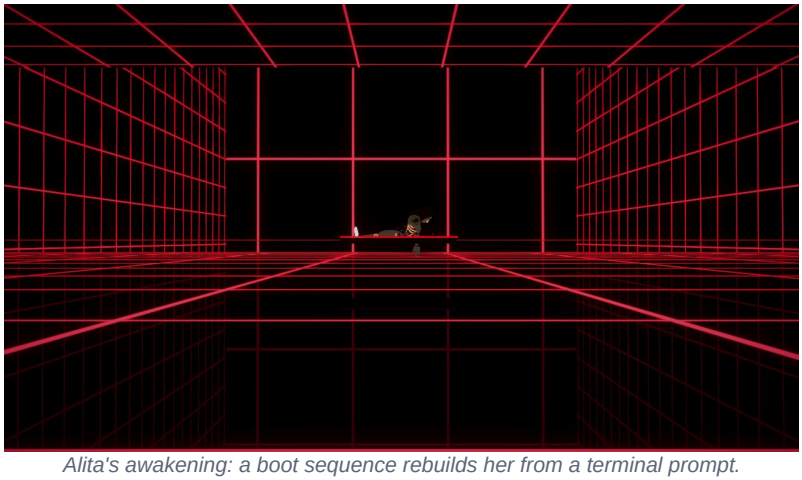
The story in brief

A nameless cyborg is pulled from the scrap beneath a floating city. The people who made her want her back, and the man who saved her pays for it.

Iron City sits in the shadow of Zalem, the sky city that drops its waste on everyone below. The Factory runs the district through bounty hunters, and unregistered tech is fair game. Dr. Dyson Ido, a cyber-surgeon and hunter-warrior, finds a warm Martian core and an intact brain in the slag heaps and rebuilds them into a porcelain doll body. The girl who wakes has no memories, no serial tag and no registry footprint: to the city, she does not exist.

Ido walks her out into the Sector 4 plaza and warns her that strangers get hit first. Then a corporate bounty unit seals the Sector 7 Skybridge and announces what the city wants: *"The core is worth more than your whole district."* Alita fights back and finds that her body remembers a martial art she cannot name. From that bridge her story becomes a chain of questions. Who ordered the strike, why is her core worth a district, and what exactly was she before the scrapyard?

The answers lie in the Pit, in the Blackwall, in a smuggler's port and finally on Mars. Each step costs her something, and the biggest cost is Ido.



Alita's awakening: a boot sequence rebuilds her from a terminal prompt.

Who matters

Alita	A rebuilt Martian war cyborg (designation URM-004, Berserker Unit 99). She starts with no memory and a body that remembers how to fight.
Dr. Dyson Ido	The cyber-surgeon who rebuilds her and guides her through the city. Her only anchor.
Forge-Lord Vulcan	Master of the Pit and the man behind the strike on the bridge. He sends bots first, then comes himself.
Cynosure-09	The Erebus Matriarch: a rogue AI whose face is 16 m of light, living in the Blackwall. Knows what the megacorp did and what Alita lost.
Kaelen Voss, The Collector	Fixer and syndicate overlord at the Drift. Sells Alita the way to Mars, then sells her out. His last message tells her what waits there.
Colossus-06	A Titan war mech with a rocket war hammer, the corporate muscle waiting on Mars.
The Corporation Overseer	A robed, gold-masked figure above the megacorporations. Seen only in the epilogue.

The story in eight chapters

CHAPTER 1

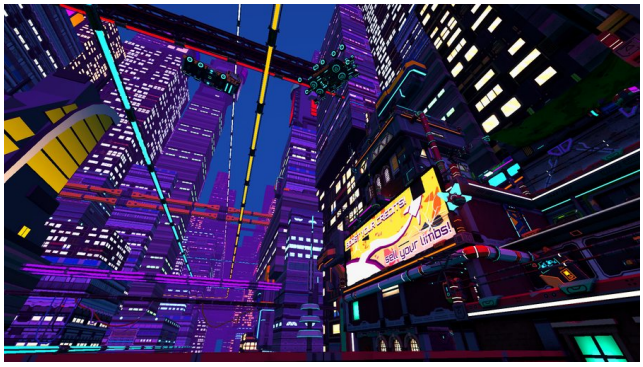
Found in the scrap

Under acid rain and lightning, Ido combs the scrap heaps and finds a cyborg torso with a living brain and a pulsing antimatter core. In one unbroken shot he clears the debris, scans her vitals and carries her home. In his clinic he builds her a new body. When her eyes open, Ido has to tell her the hard part: her memory blocks were wiped clean, and the core she carries is the only reason anyone would ever look for her.

CHAPTER 2

The Sector 7 Skybridge

Ido takes her up through the catwalks to the Sector 4 plaza and shows her the city: Zalem hanging overhead, salvage queues, Vector enforcers on the gantries. He warns her that people here are paranoid and some will swing at a stranger on sight. Further on, a rogue security detachment has locked the Skybridge. Ido pleads with them (*"She's just a girl"*) and is ignored. The ambush springs, Alita takes the lead, and her hands fall into a stance that Ido recognises from pre-collapse military codices. She destroys Vulcan's recovery bots one by one.



Cyber City: the vertical sprawl Alita has to climb through.



The Drift market, where everything is for sale.

CHAPTER 3

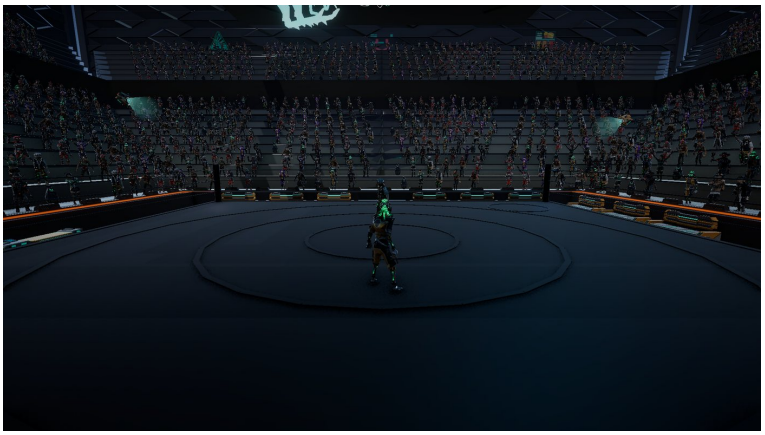
The pass

Ido leaves her an emergency message. The hit squads found them on the bridge, and a Razor scalper near the bridge is flashing a spare Pit pass. *"Take the pass with your blade. Enter the Pit arena... and find who ordered the strike."* Alita hunts the scalper across a long chase from the Skybridge through the terraces and the clinic plaza to a lower-alley van, corners him in a duel and takes the pass.

CHAPTER 4

The Pit

The pass opens the 56-metre colosseum. Alita climbs the gladiator ladder in front of 550 roaring spectators and earns her first purse in euro-dollars. At the top of the ladder the lights die, the drums stop and the jumbotron glitches. Forge-Lord Vulcan drops into the ring and delivers a speech: *"You broke my toys on the bridge. Stole my pass. Shamed my Pit... I sent troops. You sent back scrap. So now the Forge comes himself."* A three-phase duel follows, from the duelist to the meltdown surge to the judgement of the forge. When Alita wins, the district sees it. Ido calls to tell her that her reputation has changed the city: *"They'll only run from you now."*



The Pit: the colosseum where Alita takes on Vulcan.

CHAPTER 5

Ido falls

Back on the sky terrace, Ido's voice comes over her comms, strained and urgent: he is on a bridge and cornered, and he needs her. Alita runs. Before she reaches him, Vulcan steps out behind Ido, stabs him and throws him off the bridge. The victory in the Pit cost her the one person it was meant to protect. All Ido leaves behind is a trace: a signal coming from a sealed server room. Alita takes it, and the door opens onto the Blackwall.

CHAPTER 6

Beyond the Blackwall

On the other side lies a vast mirror-floored cyberspace and a 200-metre wall of living data that holds the rogue AIs back. Cynosure-09 rises out of it as a 16-metre face of light. She tells Alita that the megacorporation killed Ido because they feared what he was sheltering: Alita. And she tells her something worse: *"You do NOT possess your true Antimatter Core. The Berserker heart that powered your Martian chassis was stripped away before Ido found you in the scrap."* She offers the coordinates of Alita's lost starship, and asks Alita to choose a path: avenge Ido, seek the core, or rebel against the machines. Waves of holographic rogue-AI fighters, ending in a master overseer, test the answer. A starship materialises out of the data stream and Alita boards it.



The sealed server room at the end of Ido's last signal.



The door opens onto the Blackwall.

CHAPTER 7

The Drift

Her ship carries her to the Drift, a lawless port built into an asteroid belt. The only way to the core is Mars, and the only man who sells the way to Mars is Kaelen Voss, the Collector. His price is four stolen core matrices drifting outside the broken dome. Alita flies out, locks onto them with a tractor beam and brings them back to power the reactor. Then Voss shows his hand: *"Did you really think I'd let you walk away with the coordinates, Alita? Omni-Corp's bounty on your intact chassis is mine! Kill her!"* The gantry supports are cut, the catwalk collapses and Alita falls into the cargo trench with the Syndicate hunters and a hover tank after her. She grabs the coordinates, fights her way back up and escapes from Pad B-04 into hyperspace.

As she goes, a hijacked message from Voss plays: the core is in a shielded partition under the manifest, and the coordinates were always hers. His dead man's switch adds a last warning: *"Cydonia. Sub-level nine. And Alita... there are rows of them down there. Cores. Bodies. All wearing your face."*



The Drift: Voss's asteroid port, a market where the only thing not for sale is the truth.

CHAPTER 8

Mars

Alita drops out of hyperspace over the Cydonia Basin and punches through a dust storm beneath Phobos. Operation Red Horizon begins with a crashed Martian warship. Inside it she recovers the antimatter Berserker core: her heart. When it syncs the combat limiters disengage and her output hits 500 percent. Outside, two imperial dreadnoughts break through the clouds, an expeditionary force surrounds her, and Colossus-06, a Titan war mech with a rocket hammer, steps forward. It is the fight she was built for. For the first time she fights it for herself.

The story closes in deep space. The robed Corporation Overseer, who has watched all of it, turns to face her, and it is clear that the people who rebuilt Alita, buried her and sold her will not stop at one mech.

The arc at a glance

Chapter	Where	What Alita gains or loses
1. Found in the scrap	Scrapyard, Ido's clinic	A body, a guardian, and no memory
2. The Sector 7 Skybridge	Plaza, catwalks, bridge	Her first fight; her body remembers more than she does
3. The pass	City terraces, lower alley	A way into the Pit and the first thread toward whoever sent the hit squads
4. The Pit	56 m colosseum	A champion's name; the district's fear and respect
5. Ido falls	The bridge, the server room	Loses Ido; gains a signal to follow
6. Beyond the Blackwall	Cyberspace	Learns her core was stripped; chooses her path; gains a ship
7. The Drift	Asteroid port	Betrayed by Voss; gets the coordinates and a warning about Cydonia
8. Mars	Cydonia Basin	Recovers her heart and faces the war machine; the Overseer waits

Themes

- **Weapon or person:** Alita is built for war and keeps choosing what to fight for.
- **Found family and loss:** Ido gives her a life, and losing him is the turning point of the story.
- **Identity:** every chapter takes something from her and gives back a piece of what she was, ending with the reveal of what was done to her.
- **Corporate cruelty:** Zalem discards, the Factory hunts, Omni-Corp pays bounties and the Overseer owns it all.
- **Trust and betrayal:** Vulcan, Voss and the corporations show the cost of trusting power.